

Ritwik Bhattacharjee

Strategic Communications & Thought Leadership Professional

Vancouver, BC | ritwik.bhattacharjee@ubc.ca | (672) 513-2954 | linkedin.com/in/rb85

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic communications professional with 9+ years of experience leading integrated communications, thought leadership, executive communications, editorial strategy, stakeholder engagement, digital communications, event communications and public-facing storytelling across higher education, publishing, research and community organizations. Known for translating complex ideas into compelling narratives that strengthen institutional reputation, build trust, and engage diverse audiences.

CORE EXPERTISE

Strategic Communications | Executive Communications | Thought Leadership | Editorial Strategy | Stakeholder Engagement | Public Engagement | Research Storytelling | Digital Communications | Event Communications | Media Relations | Audience Growth | Brand Storytelling | Issues-aware Communications | Project Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Communications Specialist

University of British Columbia - Faculty of Arts, School of Music, Department of History | Vancouver, BC | 2024-Present

- Lead strategic communications for multiple academic units, partnering with leaders to strengthen institutional reputation, audience engagement and public-facing storytelling.
- Created and led Arts Perspectives on AI, a six-part thought leadership series based on interviews with faculty and alumni experts across journalism, music, Indigenous data stewardship, linguistics, higher education and public policy.
- Expanded the AI series to UBC's central Generative AI website; articles were featured through UBC channels and republished by BC Studies and The Ubysey.
- Produced one of UBC Faculty of Arts' highest-performing feature stories, reaching 16,000+ readers and becoming the second most-viewed story on arts.ubc.ca.
- Led communications and design support for JWAM's 25th Anniversary public event, AI in Our World: Shaping Media, Education, and Science, at UBC Robson Square.
- Increased newsletter audience by 410% and social media engagement by 80% through editorial planning, segmentation and integrated digital communications strategy.

Graduate Academic Assistant, Communications

Centre for Migration Studies, University of British Columbia | Vancouver, BC | 2023

- Produced communications supporting research dissemination, institutional visibility and stakeholder engagement.
- Developed newsletters, annual reports, websites, presentations, feature stories and digital communications.
- Translated complex interdisciplinary research into accessible communications for academic, community, government and public audiences.

Communications Manager / Circulation Manager

Tudor Rose Publishing & Marketing Services | Leicester, United Kingdom | 2010-2023

- Directed integrated communications, marketing, circulation and audience development across international publications serving government, healthcare, infrastructure, education and business sectors.
- Generated approximately £175,000 in new business through strategic partnerships, sponsorships and communications initiatives.
- Reduced operating costs by approximately £65,000 and influenced procurement decisions resulting in annual savings exceeding £16,000.
- Managed circulation budgets exceeding £180,000 and supported digital transformation initiatives that produced 172% audience growth.

Vice President, Operations & Marketing

South Kolkata Citizens' Committee / Nagarik Samity | Kolkata, India | 2016-2020

- Directed communications, sponsorship, fundraising, marketing and community engagement for large-scale cultural programming.
- Coordinated 36 volunteers supporting cultural festivals that attracted 150,000+ attendees and led fundraising exceeding INR 3 million.

SELECTED WRITING & PROJECTS

- Arts Perspectives on AI - six-part UBC Faculty of Arts thought leadership series.
- Reclaiming History - Asian-Indigenous exhibit feature on truth-telling and historical memory.

- A Night of Music at the Learning Exchange - School of Music community-engagement feature reshared by UBC Learning Exchange.
- David Metzger faculty research feature - musicians confronting the U.S. prison system.
- Dalit History Month Roundtable - Department of History public dialogue and equity-focused event story.

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

- PhD Candidate in Interdisciplinary Studies, currently ABD, University of British Columbia.
- MA, International Relations, Middlesex University.
- BA (Hons), Political Science, Jadavpur University.
- Selected recognition: Killam Graduate Teaching Assistant Award; UBC Four Year Fellowship; President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award; Faculty of Graduate Studies Graduate Awards; International Tuition Award; South Asia Regional Academic Scholarship.

EDITORIAL & ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

- Editor-in-Chief, Mantle: The Annual Review of Interdisciplinary Studies.
- Senior Graduate Teaching Assistant and Graduate Teaching Assistant across Political Science and First Nations and Indigenous Studies at UBC.